

# Nonprofit and NGO English

Instructor guide for advanced ESL learners working in nonprofit and ngo

**Audience: nonprofit program managers, NGO staff, grant writers, development officers, monitoring and evaluation teams, field coordinators, volunteer managers, and nonprofit executives**

Focus: A nonprofit and NGO English curriculum for donor communication, grants, program evaluation, field operations, safeguarding, community partnerships, volunteer management, and mission-versus-budget tradeoffs.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

## Purpose and Course Logic

A nonprofit and NGO English curriculum for donor communication, grants, program evaluation, field operations, safeguarding, community partnerships, volunteer management, and mission-versus-budget tradeoffs.

### Core language challenge

Advanced learners do not only need vocabulary. They need the ability to ask which standard applies, who owns the decision, what evidence is sufficient, what risk is being accepted, and how to disagree without sounding vague, defensive, or reckless.

Each module trains a realistic workplace pressure point with role-specific terms, decision language, pushback practice, and bounded decision activities learners can apply to their own work.

### Course objectives

- Use nonprofit and ngo terminology accurately in meetings, written updates, handoffs, escalations, reviews, and client or stakeholder conversations.
- Turn vague requests into specific questions about evidence, owner, deadline, constraint, risk, and decision rights.
- Push back on unsafe, unsupported, noncompliant, unrealistic, or poorly scoped proposals while preserving professional trust.
- Handle realistic dialogues from the field, including conflict, uncertainty, documentation gaps, customer or stakeholder pressure, and cross-functional disagreement.
- Select language that produces concise workplace outputs: briefing notes, escalation updates, meeting scripts, risk memos, decision records, and follow-up messages.

## Instructor Module Plans

### Module 1. Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design (90 minutes)

Connect mission language to measurable program logic.

#### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: mission, theory of change, output, outcome.
- Explain the workplace tension: Inputs, activities, outputs, outcomes, assumptions, and evidence need alignment.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Use inspirational stories only.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a theory-of-change explanation.

#### Customized scenario

##### Workplace pressure

A donor asks how activities create outcomes.

Use inspirational stories only.

Inputs, activities, outputs, outcomes, assumptions, and evidence need alignment.

#### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.

4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a theory-of-change explanation.

## Module 2. Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions (90 minutes)

Write compelling proposals while respecting restrictions.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: restricted funding, deliverable, grant proposal, mission fit.
- Explain the workplace tension: Mission fit, restricted funds, capacity, and reporting obligations need review.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Accept it because funding is scarce.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a grant-fit recommendation.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A funder offers money for work outside the mission.

Accept it because funding is scarce.

Mission fit, restricted funds, capacity, and reporting obligations need review.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a grant-fit recommendation.

## Module 3. Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (90 minutes)

Discuss impact evidence without overclaiming.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: indicator, baseline, attribution, learning agenda.
- Explain the workplace tension: Indicators, baseline, attribution, qualitative evidence, and limitations matter.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Call the program successful.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for an evaluation caveat paragraph.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A report shows improved participation but unclear outcomes.

Call the program successful.

Indicators, baseline, attribution, qualitative evidence, and limitations matter.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.

3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a evaluation caveat paragraph.

## Module 4. Field Operations and Partner Coordination (90 minutes)

Communicate operational risk in community settings.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: implementing partner, field visit, contingency, community trust.
- Explain the workplace tension: Local constraints, safety, community trust, budget, and contingency planning matter.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Pressure the partner publicly.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a partner recovery plan.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A local partner cannot deliver services on the agreed timeline.

Pressure the partner publicly.

Local constraints, safety, community trust, budget, and contingency planning matter.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a partner recovery plan.

## Module 5. Safeguarding and Incident Reporting (90 minutes)

Escalate sensitive concerns with care.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: safeguarding, confidentiality, survivor-centered, incident report.
- Explain the workplace tension: Safeguarding policy, confidentiality, survivor-centered response, and investigation process apply.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Ask the staff member informally.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a safeguarding intake note.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A volunteer reports possible misconduct by a staff member.

Ask the staff member informally.

Safeguarding policy, confidentiality, survivor-centered response, and investigation process apply.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.

2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a safeguarding intake note.

## Module 6. Volunteer Management and Training (90 minutes)

Set expectations for volunteers without discouraging them.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: volunteer role, training, supervision, duty of care.
- Explain the workplace tension: Role scope, training, supervision, risk, and client dignity matter.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Let them help wherever needed.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a volunteer boundary script.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

Volunteers want to perform tasks beyond their training.

Let them help wherever needed.

Role scope, training, supervision, risk, and client dignity matter.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a volunteer boundary script.

## Module 7. Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality (90 minutes)

Communicate advocacy positions responsibly.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: advocacy, campaign, dignity, source.
- Explain the workplace tension: Source, context, dignity, legal status, and organizational position need review.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Use it because it gets attention.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for an advocacy message review.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A campaign team wants to use a dramatic statistic.

Use it because it gets attention.

Source, context, dignity, legal status, and organizational position need review.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a advocacy message review.

## Module 8. Board Reporting and Sustainability (90 minutes)

Present program and financial reality without panic.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: board governance, cash runway, reserve, scenario.
- Explain the workplace tension: Scenario planning, reserves, restricted funds, staffing, and mission impact need clarity.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Ask the board for emergency funds without options.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a board sustainability update.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

Cash runway is tightening while demand rises.

Ask the board for emergency funds without options.

Scenario planning, reserves, restricted funds, staffing, and mission impact need clarity.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a board sustainability update.

## Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

### Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design

| Term    | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                             | Collocations                         | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| mission | In nonprofit and ngo, mission is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to connect mission language to measurable program logic. | clarify mission;<br>document mission | Contrast: mission should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify mission and the evidence that supports it. |

| Term             | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Collocations                                        | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| theory of change | In nonprofit and ngo, theory of change is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to connect mission language to measurable program logic. | clarify theory of change; document theory of change | Contrast: theory of change should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify theory of change and the evidence that supports it. |
| output           | In nonprofit and ngo, output is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to connect mission language to measurable program logic.           | clarify output; document output                     | Contrast: output should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify output and the evidence that supports it.                     |
| outcome          | In nonprofit and ngo, outcome is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to connect mission language to measurable program logic.          | clarify outcome; document outcome                   | Contrast: outcome should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify outcome and the evidence that supports it.                   |

## Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions

| Term               | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Collocations                                            | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| restricted funding | In nonprofit and ngo, restricted funding is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to write compelling proposals while respecting restrictions. | clarify restricted funding; document restricted funding | Contrast: restricted funding should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify restricted funding and the evidence that supports it. |
| deliverable        | In nonprofit and ngo, deliverable is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to write compelling proposals while respecting restrictions.        | clarify deliverable; document deliverable               | Contrast: deliverable should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify deliverable and the evidence that supports it.               |
| grant proposal     | In nonprofit and ngo, grant proposal is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to write compelling proposals while respecting restrictions.     | clarify grant proposal; document grant proposal         | Contrast: grant proposal should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify grant proposal and the evidence that supports it.         |
| mission fit        | In nonprofit and ngo, mission fit is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to write compelling proposals while respecting restrictions.        | clarify mission fit; document mission fit               | Contrast: mission fit should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify mission fit and the evidence that supports it.               |

## Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning

| Term      | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                       | Collocations                          | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| indicator | In nonprofit and ngo, indicator is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss impact evidence without overclaiming. | clarify indicator; document indicator | Contrast: indicator should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify indicator and the evidence that supports it. |

| Term            | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Collocations                                         | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| baseline        | In nonprofit and ngo, baseline is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss impact evidence without overclaiming.                    | clarify baseline;<br>document baseline               | Contrast: baseline should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify baseline and the evidence that supports it.               |
| attribution     | In nonprofit and ngo, attribution is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to discuss impact evidence without overclaiming.       | clarify attribution;<br>document attribution         | Contrast: attribution should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify attribution and the evidence that supports it.         |
| learning agenda | In nonprofit and ngo, learning agenda is a structured course of action that assigns priorities, sequencing, assumptions, and responsible roles. Use it when teams need to discuss impact evidence without overclaiming. | clarify learning agenda;<br>document learning agenda | Contrast: learning agenda should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify learning agenda and the evidence that supports it. |

## Field Operations and Partner Coordination

| Term                 | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Collocations                                                   | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| implementing partner | In nonprofit and ngo, implementing partner is a stakeholder category whose needs, eligibility, experience, or obligations affect the decision. Use it when teams need to communicate operational risk in community settings. | clarify implementing partner;<br>document implementing partner | Contrast: implementing partner should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify implementing partner and the evidence that supports it. |
| field visit          | In nonprofit and ngo, field visit is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate operational risk in community settings.                | clarify field visit;<br>document field visit                   | Contrast: field visit should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify field visit and the evidence that supports it.                   |
| contingency          | In nonprofit and ngo, contingency is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate operational risk in community settings.                | clarify contingency;<br>document contingency                   | Contrast: contingency should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify contingency and the evidence that supports it.                   |
| community trust      | In nonprofit and ngo, community trust is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate operational risk in community settings.            | clarify community trust;<br>document community trust           | Contrast: community trust should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify community trust and the evidence that supports it.           |

## Safeguarding and Incident Reporting

| Term         | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                            | Collocations                                   | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| safeguarding | In nonprofit and ngo, safeguarding is a repeatable control mechanism used to prevent, detect, or confirm conditions before work proceeds. Use it when teams need to escalate sensitive concerns with care. | clarify safeguarding;<br>document safeguarding | Contrast: safeguarding should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify safeguarding and the evidence that supports it. |



| Term              | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Collocations                                             | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| confidentiality   | In nonprofit and ngo, confidentiality is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to escalate sensitive concerns with care.                   | clarify confidentiality;<br>document confidentiality     | Contrast: confidentiality should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify confidentiality and the evidence that supports it.     |
| survivor-centered | In nonprofit and ngo, survivor-centered is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to escalate sensitive concerns with care.                 | clarify survivor-centered;<br>document survivor-centered | Contrast: survivor-centered should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify survivor-centered and the evidence that supports it. |
| incident report   | In nonprofit and ngo, incident report is a workplace communication artifact that records facts, interpretation, and the decision or action requested. Use it when teams need to escalate sensitive concerns with care. | assess incident report;<br>mitigate incident report      | Contrast: incident report identifies a possible or current exposure; it is not the same as accepting that exposure. Example: We need to assess incident report, name the owner, and agree on the trigger for escalation.              |

## Volunteer Management and Training

| Term           | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Collocations                                       | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| volunteer role | In nonprofit and ngo, volunteer role is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to set expectations for volunteers without discouraging them.             | clarify volunteer role;<br>document volunteer role | Contrast: volunteer role should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify volunteer role and the evidence that supports it. |
| training       | In nonprofit and ngo, training is a capability or authorization process used to prepare, verify, or document that a person can perform a role. Use it when teams need to set expectations for volunteers without discouraging them. | clarify training;<br>document training             | Contrast: training should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify training and the evidence that supports it.             |
| supervision    | In nonprofit and ngo, supervision is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to set expectations for volunteers without discouraging them.                | clarify supervision;<br>document supervision       | Contrast: supervision should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify supervision and the evidence that supports it.       |
| duty of care   | In nonprofit and ngo, duty of care is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to set expectations for volunteers without discouraging them.               | clarify duty of care;<br>document duty of care     | Contrast: duty of care should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify duty of care and the evidence that supports it.     |

## Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality

| Term     | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                    | Collocations                           | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| advocacy | In nonprofit and ngo, advocacy is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate advocacy positions responsibly. | clarify advocacy;<br>document advocacy | Contrast: advocacy should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify advocacy and the evidence that supports it. |

| Term     | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Collocations                           | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| campaign | In nonprofit and ngo, campaign is a communication or market-facing element that must match evidence, audience, channel, and approval boundaries. Use it when teams need to communicate advocacy positions responsibly. | clarify campaign;<br>document campaign | Contrast: campaign should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify campaign and the evidence that supports it. |
| dignity  | In nonprofit and ngo, dignity is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate advocacy positions responsibly.                      | clarify dignity;<br>document dignity   | Contrast: dignity should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify dignity and the evidence that supports it.   |
| source   | In nonprofit and ngo, source is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate advocacy positions responsibly.                       | clarify source;<br>document source     | Contrast: source should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify source and the evidence that supports it.     |

## Board Reporting and Sustainability

| Term             | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Collocations                                           | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| board governance | In nonprofit and ngo, board governance is a decision-accountability mechanism that clarifies who recommends, approves, performs, and accepts risk. Use it when teams need to present program and financial reality without panic. | clarify board governance;<br>document board governance | Contrast: board governance should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify board governance and the evidence that supports it. |
| cash runway      | In nonprofit and ngo, cash runway is a measurable indicator used to quantify performance, exposure, capacity, quality, or change over time. Use it when teams need to present program and financial reality without panic.        | track cash runway;<br>explain a change in cash runway  | Contrast: cash runway measures a result or condition; it does not, by itself, prove the cause. Example: Before we act, let us track cash runway by segment and explain what changed.                                                |
| reserve          | In nonprofit and ngo, reserve is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to present program and financial reality without panic.                        | clarify reserve;<br>document reserve                   | Contrast: reserve should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify reserve and the evidence that supports it.                   |
| scenario         | In nonprofit and ngo, scenario is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to present program and financial reality without panic.                       | clarify scenario;<br>document scenario                 | Contrast: scenario should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify scenario and the evidence that supports it.                 |

## Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

| Situation                                     | Useful language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design | Before we commit, I want to confirm mission, theory of change, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If inputs, activities, outputs, outcomes, assumptions, and evidence need alignment., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step. |

| Situation                                  | Useful language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions     | Before we commit, I want to confirm restricted funding, deliverable, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If mission fit, restricted funds, capacity, and reporting obligations need review., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                  |
| Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning       | Before we commit, I want to confirm indicator, baseline, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If indicators, baseline, attribution, qualitative evidence, and limitations matter., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                             |
| Field Operations and Partner Coordination  | Before we commit, I want to confirm implementing partner, field visit, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If local constraints, safety, community trust, budget, and contingency planning matter., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.           |
| Safeguarding and Incident Reporting        | Before we commit, I want to confirm safeguarding, confidentiality, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If safeguarding policy, confidentiality, survivor-centered response, and investigation process apply., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step. |
| Volunteer Management and Training          | Before we commit, I want to confirm volunteer role, training, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If role scope, training, supervision, risk, and client dignity matter., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                                     |
| Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality | Before we commit, I want to confirm advocacy, campaign, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If source, context, dignity, legal status, and organizational position need review., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                              |
| Board Reporting and Sustainability         | Before we commit, I want to confirm board governance, cash runway, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If scenario planning, reserves, restricted funds, staffing, and mission impact need clarity., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.          |

## High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

## Assessment and Coaching

### Performance rubric

| Skill                  | Developing                                           | Proficient                                               | Strong                                                                                    |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Terminology            | Recognizes terms but uses them loosely.              | Uses field terms accurately in context.                  | Defines terms, connects them to evidence, and explains decision impact.                   |
| Pushback               | Disagrees vaguely or avoids disagreement.            | Names concern with evidence and next step.               | Balances urgency, relationship, risk, owner, and decision rights.                         |
| Scenario judgment      | Focuses on one stakeholder's preference.             | Identifies constraint, risk, and process.                | Guides the group toward a documented, realistic decision.                                 |
| Decision communication | Selects language without linking it to the decision. | Chooses language that names facts, owner, and next step. | Distinguishes evidence, tradeoff, authority, and escalation in a decision-ready response. |

### Source orientation

- Donor agreements and grant restrictions.

- Safeguarding and incident-reporting policies.
- Monitoring, evaluation, and learning standards.
- The learner's own company policies, SOPs, contracts, systems, templates, and approved communication standards.